

Veterinary Science

Whilst my dream, to aid conservation projects in Africa, motivates me to become a veterinarian, it is the reality which really interests me: the opportunity to study medical science while helping animals. I have learned that work of a vet can be challenging, exhausting and thankless, yet invigorating, rewarding and emotionally engaging. I wish to pursue this path for all of these reasons.

During a two week placement at a busy 24 hour referral hospital, two cases in particular - a fractious cat that would not tolerate chemotherapy, and an otherwise healthy cat reblocked with a urinary obstruction that was euthanised because her owners couldn't afford a catheterisation and cystotomy - gave me an understanding of the monetary and behavioural restrictions that so often limit treatment options. Observing countless difficult consultations with disagreeable and worried clients, I have come to understand the significance of communication, sensitivity and expectation management in a vet's work.

Farming for two and a half weeks with over three thousand sheep, four hundred beef and dairy cows, I was taught to monitor the welfare of livestock, and identified and helped treat mastitis and foot rot (whilst trimming hooves). I became familiar with the cost/benefit analysis of any livestock treatment, and this was driven home during my time at a Knackery. The euthanasia of a lame ewe lamb with a veterinary bill exceeding its potential worth made me appreciate the, sometimes unfeeling, commercial influence in the large animal veterinary world. On weekends I have been volunteering at a riding stables, and have learnt some basic nursing skills in the kennels of a local clinic.

In preparation for my weeks in practice I read 'How we die' by Sherwin Nuland and 'The Rise and Fall of Modern Medicine' (James Le Fanu), to better understand the cases. Outside of medical science, I read 'Mutants' by Armand Leroi after a lecture by Prof. Steve Jones, and became very interested in the

concept of deep homology and especially enjoyed learning more about evo-devo in 'Endless forms Most Beautiful' by Sean Carroll.

At school, I have learnt many valuable lessons in maintaining studiousness and civility with little sleep through my experiences with theatre. I received a 96% distinction in RADA Shakespeare and have acted in (and once written and directed) 17 public productions over my time at Tiffin. I also rowed competitively for the school boat club, a sport similarly requiring exceptionally close-knit, devoted teams. In my final year I was awarded the Prince and Turner Prizes, both for outstanding academic achievement over seven years.

Over my gap year I will be spending one month on a camel farm in Kenya and two weeks a vets in the Philippines, alongside part time work on a dairy farm (calving in March) and a sheep farm (lambing in March and April), weekly work at a local stables, and I have confirmed equine and farm practice placements in Dorset. I will also be travelling in South America and spending some more time shadowing a farrier.

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